



INTRODUCTION TO ISLAM

FACULTY OF ISLAMIC STUDIES

GENERAL EDUCATION

DIHPE - DOW UNIVERSITY OF HEALTH SCIENCES (DUHS)

Topic # I

Lecture # II

The Holy Quran

(Introduction, Revelation and Compilation)

INTRODUCTION

- There are 114 **Surahs** in the Holy Quran. The word “**Surah**” means status, height, pitch, boundary, or elevation. In the context of the Holy Quran, a **Surah** refers to a chapter.
- Each Surah consists of verses called “**Ayahs.**” The word “**Ayah**” means a sign or miracle. Thus, every Ayah of the Holy Quran is a sign of the Greatness of Allah. Every Ayah is also a miracle in the sense that no creature among humans, jinn, or angels can produce anything like it.
- The Holy Quran is divided into **30 parts**, called “**Paras,**” and **seven divisions**, each called a “**Manzil.**”
- The revelation of the Holy Quran began when Prophet Muhammad (SAW) was **40 years old**, while he was in the **Cave of Hira**, approximately three miles from Makkah.

اقْرَأْ بِاسْمِ رَبِّكَ الَّذِي خَلَقَ - خَلَقَ الْإِنْسَانَ مِنْ عَلَقٍ - اقْرَأْ وَرَبُّكَ الْأَكْرَمُ -
الَّذِي عَلَّمَ بِالْقَلَمِ - عَلَّمَ الْإِنْسَانَ مَا لَمْ يَعْلَمْ

“Read! In the Name of your Lord, Who has created (all that exists), Has created man from a clot. Read! And your Lord is the Most Generous, Who has taught (the writing) by the pen. Has taught man that which he knew not,” [Al-‘Alaq 96: 1-5].

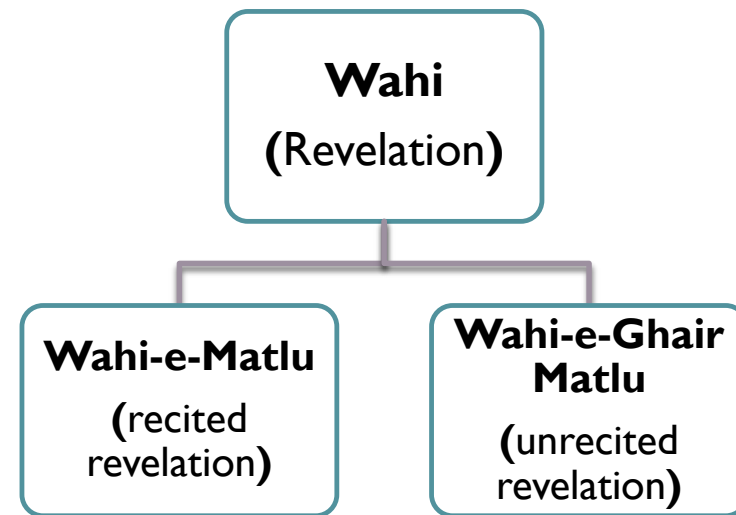
DIVINE REVELATION

Revelation (وَحْي)

The Arabic word **Wahi** (وَحْي) comes from the root word (وَحَى) waha and is used to describe divine revelation.

It has a variety of different meanings in the Arabic language, being interpreted as “a quick or divine indication”, “to give or convey a message” or “gentle speech”.

Types of Revelation



NAMES OF THE HOLY QUR'AN

- * Al' Shifa (Healing, The Cure) - (10:57) (17:82) (41:44)
- * Al-Kitab (The Scripture) - (21:10)
- * Al-Noor (The Light) - (7:157)
- * Al-Hukm (The Judgment) - (13:37)
- * Al-Zhikr (The Reminder) - (15:9)
- * Al-Furqan (The Criterion for judging right from wrong) - (25:1)
- * Al-Tanzil (The Revelation) - (26:192)

The Meaning of Word “Quran”

- The word “Qur’an (قُرْآن) is a verbal noun (maṣḍar) derived from the Arabic verb “Qara’a (قَرَأَ) (which means “to read” or “to recite.”
- Thus, the word “Qur’an” literally means “recitation” or “reading.”
- The term “Qur’an” has historically been used specifically to refer to the Divine Book revealed to Prophet Muhammad ﷺ .

DEFINITION OF QURAN

What is the definition of Quran?

“The Quran is the Word of Allah (Kalām Allah), revealed to His Prophet Muhammad (SAW) through the Angel Jibrīl (Gabriel), transmitted to us through continuous chains of narration known as “Tawātur,” and recited as an act of worship.

It begins with Surah Al-Fātiḥah and ends with Surah An-Nās.

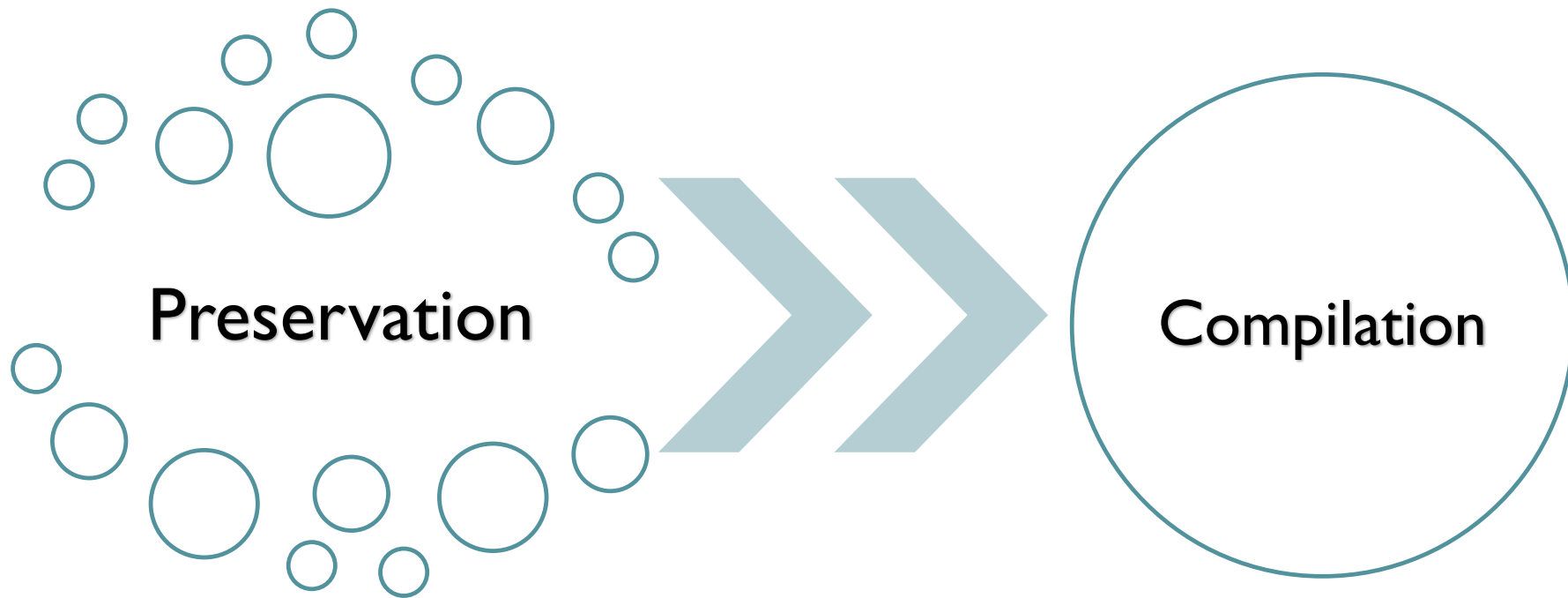
The Quran is also a miraculous revelation that challenges humankind to produce even the shortest Surah like it.

After the first revelation of the Holy Quran, there was a period of "Fatratul Wahi" or "The pause between the revelation" when no further revelation was received by Prophet Muhammad (SAW).

This period allowed for spiritual preparation, settling of the new message, and reflection on the enormity of his mission.

	Makki Surahs	Madni Surahs
Place of Revelation	Revealed in Makkah	Revealed in Madinah
Time of Revelation	First 13 years of Prophet's (SAWW) mission	After migration to Madinah (Its period is more or less 10 years.)
Subject Matter	Tauhid (the oneness of Allah) and Risalat (Prophet hood) Matters of faith, morality, and spiritual guidance	Deal with rules and regulation of Islam, Matters of law, governance, and social issues
Style of Language	More difficult, and emotional	More direct, easy, and practical
Examples of Surahs	Al-Fatiha (1), Al-Ikhlās (112), Al-An'am (6)	Al-Baqarah (2), Al-Imran (3), Al-Ma'ida (5)
Example of Verse	"Say: He is Allah, the One and Only..." (Al-Ikhlās, 112)	"O ye who believe! Fasting is prescribed to you..." (Al-Baqarah, 2:183)

HISTORY OF QURAN



THE PRESERVATION

- The Quran will always be protected from change and alterations, for Allah says:

إِنَّا نَحْنُ نَزَّلْنَا الذِّكْرَ وَإِنَّا لَهُ لَحَافِظُونَ (٩)

“It is certainly We Who have revealed the Reminder (Dhikar), and it is certainly We Who will preserve it.” (15:9)

- The Quran contains no contradictions, for Allah says:

أَفَلَا يَتَدَبَّرُونَ الْقُرْآنَ وَلَوْ كَانَ مِنْ عِنْدِ غَيْرِ اللَّهِ لَوَجَدُوا فِيهِ
أَخْتِلَافًا كَثِيرًا (٨٢)

“Do they not then reflect on the Quran? Had it been from anyone other than Allah, they would have certainly found in it many inconsistencies”. (4:82)

The Blessings of Reciting the Quran Together

When people come together to recite and study the Quran, Allah sends down tranquility upon them, covers them with mercy, surrounds them with angels, and makes mention of them among those who are with Him. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, as translated:

وعن أبي هريرة رضي الله عنه قال: قال رسول الله ﷺ : ما اجتمع قوم في بيت من بيوت الله يتلون كتاب الله، ويتدارسونه بينهم، إلا نزلت عليهم السكينة، وغشيتهم الرحمة، وحفتهم الملائكة، وذكرهم الله فيمن عنده.

(رواه مسلم)

Abu Hurairah (RA) reported: The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, “Any group of people that assemble in one of the Houses of Allah to recite the Book of Allah and study it together, tranquility will descend upon them, mercy will engulf them, angels will surround them, and Allah will make mention of them among those who are with Him.”

(Sahih Muslim, 2699)

Phases of Compilation

The compilation of the Quran may be divided into three major phases.

- First, the Quran was revealed and recorded during the lifetime of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ .
 - Then, during the Caliphate of Hazrat Abu Bakr Siddiq (RA) ,the Quran was collected into a single manuscript.
 - Finally, during the Caliphate of Hazrat Uthman ibn Affan (RA) ,the Quran was standardized and copies were prepared and distributed to various regions of the Muslim state.
1. Prophet Muhammad (SAW)'s Time: Revelation and Recording of the Quran.
 2. Hazrat Abu Bakr Siddiq (RA)'s Caliphate: Collection of the Quran into a Single Manuscript.
 3. Hazrat Uthman ibn Affan (RA)'s Caliphate: Standardization and Distribution of the Quranic Manuscripts.



FRIST PHASE

LIFE OF HOLY PROPHET MUHAMMAD ﷺ

The Prophet Muhammad (SAW) and the Memorization of the Quran

لَا تُحَرِّكْ بِهِ لِسَانَكَ لِتَعْجَلَ بِهِ ﴿٧٥:١٦﴾ إِنَّ عَلَيْنَا جَمْعَهُ وَقُرْآنَهُ ﴿٧٥:١٧﴾ فَإِذَا
قَرَأْنَاهُ فَاتَّبِعْ قُرْآنَهُ ۖ ﴿٧٥:١٨﴾ ثُمَّ إِنَّ عَلَيْنَا بَيَانَهُ ﴿٧٥:١٩﴾

“Move not your tongue with it, (O Muhammad), to hasten with recitation of the Quran. Indeed, upon Us is its collection and its recitation. So when We have recited it (through Gabriel), then follow its recitation. Then upon Us is its clarification (to you).” (Qur'an, 75:16-19)

Abu Hurairah (RA) reported:

The Prophet ﷺ used to have the Quran presented to him by Gabriel once every year, but it was presented to him twice in the year in which he passed away.

(Sahih al-Bukhari, 4998; formerly Vol. 6, Book 61, Hadith 520)

- The main method of learning was via memorization. This was a tradition among the Arabs. That was because they had a strong inclination toward poetry. Memorization and recitation were the main methods of discussion and socializing.
- Hence, Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) would memorize the passages of the Quran as Allah revealed them to him. He would then recite the verses to the companions and explain them as well.
- Zaid ibn Thabit (RA) was one of the most prominent scribes who would take down the Quran in the presence of the Prophet (PBUH). It was at this point when the names of the Surahs were likely stated and noted down.
- Additionally, Angel Jibrail (AS) would visit the Prophet (PBUH) every Ramadan and listen to him reciting the whole Quran. In the final year of his life, they went over it twice.

SECOND PHASE

ERA OF HAZRAT ABU BAKAR (RA)

The First Single Volume Manuscript of the Qur'an

- There was one main event that caused a radical change in the compilation of the Quran during this period. After the Prophet (PBUH) passed away, Abu Bakr became the Caliph of the state. However, the transition wasn't very smooth. A number of tribes that had peace treaties with the Muslims began to back out. They stated that their treaty was only with the Prophet (PBUH). Hence, they came up with demands such as refusing to pay Zakat, etc.

The Battle of Yamama

- The Battle of Yamama was fought between Muslims and rebels led by Musailmah. This battle would play a vital role in the compilation of the Quran. More than 70 memorizers were martyred during this battle, which led to the collection and compilation of the Qur'an.
- Umar bin Khattab was saddened by the casualties the Muslims suffered during the Battle of Yamama. He realized that there was no permanent book form version of Allah's Word. After the death of more than 70 huffaz (memorizers of the Quran), it was imperative that the Muslims compile the Quran.

THIRD PHASE STANDARDIZATION

Hazrat Uthman ibn Affan (RA)'s Caliphate

- After Abu Bakr's Caliphate, Islam spread far and wide in the Caliphate of Hazrat Umar. Then, Hazrat Usman was the third caliph of Islam, ruling from 644 to 656 CE. His caliphate witnessed the rapid expansion of the Muslim empire and an increasing number of non-Arab Muslims. The compilation of the Quran during the time of Hazrat Usman (Uthman ibn Affan) is an important event in Islamic history.
- Hudhaifah bin Yaman, one of the companions who had travelled during the Muslims conquests, noticed this and related the concerns to the Caliph Hazrat Uthman (RA). Hazrat Uthman (RA) took the initiative to compile a standardized version. He appointed a committee of skilled scribes, headed by Zaid ibn Thabit, a close companion of the Prophet Muhammad (SAW) and one of the primary scribes of the revelations during his lifetime.

CONTINUE...

- Hazrat Usman's compilation played a crucial role in preserving the Quran in its original form and language. It eliminated potential variations and discrepancies, ensuring that Muslims had access to a consistent and authentic version of the Quran regardless of their geographic location. This compilation became the basis for the preservation of the Quran for generations to come.

BASIC CONCEPTS OF QURAN

- The Concept of Religion
- The concept of Life
- The concept of Faith (ایمان)
- The concept of Tawheed (توحيد)
- The Concept of Prophethood
- The concept of Qadar (Fate or Predestination) (قدر / قضاء)
- The concept of Righteousness (البر)
- The concept of Taqwa (تقوى)
- The Concept of Sin
- The concept of Education or Ilm (العلم)

BASIC INFORMATION ABOUT HOLY QURAN

- Surah Al-Baqrah is the longest Surah.
- Surah Al- Kausar is the shortest Surah.
- Surah Al-Nass is the last surah.
- Surah Al-Tauba does not start with Bismillah.
- Surah Al-Namal contains two Bismillahs.
- Surah Yaseen is known as Heart of Quran.
- Suran Rehman is known as beauty of Quran.
- 25 prophets mentioned in holy Quran
- The Qur'an commands the Muslims to offer Salat (Namaz) 700 times.
- Holy Quran consist 105684 words and 3236700 letters.
- The longest Verse of Holy Quran is the 282th Verse of Surat Al-Baqarah.
- The Holy Quran comprise, of 114 Surats in which 86 have been revealed in Mecca and 28 in Madina.
- The number of verses (Ayat) are 6666.
- Ruku 558.
- Paras 30.
- Stages (Manzilain) 7.
- Bows (sajday) 14.
- Hazrat Ayesha (RA) the first person who counted the Aayaath (Verses) of the Quran.
- Abdul Malik Marwan applied the dots in the Holy Quran.
- Hazrat Khalid Bin Saeed, the first writer of Wahi.

Reference

- ❖ Islamiat (Compulsory) by Mufti Munib-ur-Rehman.
- ❖ Sirat-e-Mustaqim (Compulsory) by Abdul Qayyum Natiq.

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Topic # I

Lecture # II

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